Online Setup: Step by Step

What access I need, and why

You do not have an IT person, so I need access to every tool below to set up the website and look after it. If something breaks during an event, I can fix it without waiting for you to find a password or a screen.

TOOL	WHAT I CAN DO WITH ACCESS	WHY I NEED IT
DigitalOcean (server)	Create the server, install BOSS, update it and restart it	The website runs on it. If it stops, only someone in the account can bring it back
Domain (GoDaddy or Namecheap)	Point the website address to the server	The address does not open the site until this is done, and a wrong setting takes the site offline
Backblaze (backup storage)	Check that the daily backup copy is arriving	A backup nobody checks may not be working when it is needed
Sentry	Read error reports	It shows what went wrong, so I can fix it quickly
Cloudflare	Manage the domain's DNS and protection	A change here affects whether the website opens
UptimeRobot	Get the same "site is down" alert you get	I hear about a problem at the same time as you

What stays with you:

- You own every account and the card. I never see your card number.
- You can remove me from any tool at any time.
- I never ask for your passwords. You invite me instead.

Part A: Online server (DigitalOcean)

1. Go to **digitalocean.com** and press **Sign up**. Use an email address the organizer will keep for years, not a personal one that may change. Choose a strong password.
2. Open the email DigitalOcean sends and confirm your address.
3. When asked for a payment method, add the organizer's **debit or credit card** (Visa or Mastercard). PayPal also works. The card must be allowed to pay online in a foreign currency: if it is declined, call your bank and ask them to allow international online payments. The card is not charged on the spot. DigitalOcean bills at the end of each month, and your bank may hold a small test amount of about ₱60.
4. Give the account a name, for example "BOSS Bicol".
5. Do not create the server yourself. Go to **Settings, then Team**, press **Invite members**, and enter my email: **code.besaytejomarkristoffer@gmail.com**. Give me a role that can create and manage the server. I then set up the server. You can remove me at any time from the same page.

6. Under **Billing**, check that the card is saved and set a **billing alert** (for example ₱1,200) so you hear about unexpected charges.

Part B: Website address (domain)

1. Go to a domain seller such as **godaddy.com** or **namecheap.com**. Make an account the same way as in Part A.
2. Search for the name you want, for example `boss-bicol.com`. Pick a short, easy name that you can say out loud.
3. Buy it for **1 year** (or the 3-year offer, if you accept its terms) and pay with the card or PayPal. Turn on **auto-renew** so the site does not go offline when the year ends.
4. Add me to the domain account. Look in the account settings for an option to share access with another person (GoDaddy calls it **Delegate Access**; the name differs by seller) and enter my email. I then set the **DNS** record myself, so you do not need to edit any settings.

Part C: Backup storage (optional, recommended)

1. Go to **backblaze.com** and create a **B2 Cloud Storage** account. It also asks for a card.
2. Create a bucket (a folder) named for the event, for example `boss-backups`, and keep it **private**.
3. Invite me to the account if it has a team option. If it does not, create the account together with me on a call. Either way, create an **application key** for that bucket and send the key and its ID to me through a private message, not by email, and not in a group chat.

Part D: Free tools that help the website (optional)

All three have a free plan that is enough for BOSS. Plans and limits can change, so check each one when you sign up. Each one is created by the organizer, who gives me access, as in Part A.

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	COST	SETUP
Sentry (sentry.io)	Reports errors as they happen, with details, so I can fix a problem before teams complain.	₱0 on the free plan	Needs a small addition to BOSS's code, which I will do. You only create the account and invite me as a member.
UptimeRobot (uptimerobot.com)	Checks every few minutes that the site is up, and emails you if it goes down.	₱0 on the free plan	Enter the website address and your email. Add my email as a second alert contact, so I hear when the site goes down.
Cloudflare (cloudflare.com)	Free DNS for the domain, plus protection against attacks and bad traffic in front of the website.	₱0 on the free plan	Create the account and invite me as a member. I move the domain's DNS to Cloudflare and test it before the event.

Sentry needs one change to BOSS first (not built yet). UptimeRobot works from day one, because BOSS already has a health page at `/api/health`.

Part E: My side (the developer)

After the accounts are ready, I will:

1. Create the server, install BOSS and connect the domain. The address then opens with a padlock (HTTPS).
2. Create the first **admin** login and give it to you. You sign in and change the password right away.
3. In BOSS, open **Fees and payment details** and enter the entry fees and your GCash, Maya and bank account details. Teams cannot register until the fees are saved.
4. Connect the venue laptop, and turn on the daily backup copy.

Keeping it safe

- Use a different, strong password for each account, and turn on **two-step sign-in** (a code sent to your phone) in all of them.
- Do not send passwords or card numbers by email or chat. Invite people to the account instead.
- When the project ends, closing the DigitalOcean account stops all charges.
- Keep a note of when each payment renews: the server monthly, the domain yearly.